Which Messages Persuade? Unbundling the Effects of Chinese State Media

A Replication and Extension of Mattingly et al. (2025)

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Abstract

Mattingly et al. (2025) show in a 19-country experiment that short videos from China's state broadcaster CGTN substantially increase preference for China's political and economic models over those of the United States. I reproduce the paper's main results in Python from the authors' replication data; every coefficient, standard error, and sample size in the primary results table matches the published values. I then take up the authors' call to "unbundle" the treatments by exploiting the randomization of specific videos within treatment arms. I document how videos were actually assigned, reproduce an exploratory video-type analysis that appears in the replication code but not in the published paper, and show that it pools two arms whose effects run in opposite directions. Three findings emerge. Within the China arm, an economic rather than a second political video raises preference for China's economic model by about a quarter of a point on a six-point scale, but not preference for its political model; this holds when video position is held fixed. The economic video does not work by improving perceptions of China's growth, which are already high, while the political video does more to improve perceptions of China's leadership. And when Chinese and US videos compete head-to-head, the four CGTN videos differ markedly in persuasiveness, with the least persuasive one being the video every respondent in the China arm saw.

1 Introduction

Can an authoritarian state persuade foreign publics that its model of governance is superior? Mattingly, Incerti, Ju, Moreshead, Tanaka, and Yamagishi (2025) answer this question with a large preregistered experiment. In June 2022, they showed 6,276 respondents in 19 countries short videos produced by China's state broadcaster CGTN, by the US State Department, by both, or neither, and then asked whether they preferred the Chinese or the American political and economic model. The effects are large. Two CGTN videos raise the share of respondents preferring China's political model from 16 to 54 percent. US videos move respondents toward the American model, but by less. And when respondents see one video from each country, opinion still shifts toward China.

Each treatment in the experiment is a *bundle* of two videos, and the paper estimates the effect of each bundle as a whole. In their conclusion, the authors suggest that scholars build on their findings "by further 'unbundling' the treatments and theorizing about which specific messages are the most persuasive." This paper takes a step in that direction using the original data.

The paper makes two contributions. The first is a replication. I re-implement the authors' primary analysis in Python, starting from their analysis dataset, and reproduce all sixteen coefficients and standard errors in their primary results table exactly at the reported precision. Along the way I document how the analysis sample is constructed and several details that matter when moving the analysis from R to Python.

The second contribution is an extension. The experiment randomized not only which arm a respondent entered but also which videos they saw within it, so comparisons across videos within an arm are as credibly causal as the paper's comparisons across arms. I first document the assignment rule in the data, which differs in an informative way from the description in the paper: in the China and USA arms, every respondent saw the same political video, and only the companion video varied. I then reproduce an exploratory video-type analysis in the authors' replication code that is not reported in the paper. Its estimate of the economic-versus-political contrast matches mine, but because the Competition arm's videos are coded by their US video, it pools Competition-arm respondents with the USA arm and masks the US videos' effects. Separating the arms recovers them. Building on this, I test whether the companion-video comparison is confounded with the order in which videos were shown, examine which perceptions of China each type of content changes, and use the Competition arm's four-by-four factorial design to estimate the effect of each individual video.

The results refine the paper's account of how CGTN persuades. Economic content raises preference for China's economic model but not its political model. It does so without improving perceptions of China's growth, which most respondents already rate highly. Political content instead does more to improve perceptions that China selects competent leaders. Individual videos also differ substantially in persuasiveness, and these differences do not reduce to the economic-versus-political distinction. These patterns echo a broader point in the study of persuasion: effects estimated with a few stimuli can depend heavily on which stimuli were chosen. All within-arm comparisons rely on a small number of videos and smaller subsamples, so I report minimum detectable effects and multiple-comparison-adjusted p-values throughout and interpret null results cautiously.

2 The Original Study

Argument. Mattingly et al. (2025) argue that audiences evaluate political systems not only on democratic values but also on government performance: economic growth, stability, competent leadership, and responsiveness. Chinese state media emphasize exactly these dimensions. A second part of the argument concerns prior beliefs. Foreign audiences typically know much more about the United States than about China, so their beliefs about China are weaker and more easily moved by

new information.

Design. The experiment was fielded on Lucid between June 10 and 19, 2022, in 19 English-, Spanish-, and Arabic-speaking countries across Africa, Asia, Europe, North America, Oceania, Latin America, and the Middle East. Respondents had to pass two pre-treatment attention checks. They were then randomly assigned, within country, with equal probability to one of four arms:

- **Control**: two nature videos;
- **China**: two of four CGTN videos;
- **USA**: two of four US State Department videos;
- **Competition**: one CGTN video and one US video.

Each country's video pool contained two videos promoting its political model and two promoting its economic model. The authors selected these videos from large corpora of CGTN and State Department content which they characterize with topic models, and use text-based distance measures to show that the selected videos are representative of what each broadcaster produces.

Outcomes and estimation. The primary outcomes are two six-point scales asking whether respondents prefer the US or the Chinese political model and economic model (1 = strongly prefer the United States, 6 = strongly prefer China). The authors estimate effects by OLS with HC2 robust standard errors, both without covariates and with country fixed effects plus gender, age, education, national pride, and left–right ideology. Missing covariate values are imputed by predictive mean matching.

Findings. All three treatments have large and precisely estimated effects (Table 2). The China treatment raises preference for China's political model by 1.04 points and for its economic model by 0.87 points. The US treatment lowers them by 0.43 and 0.57 points. When the two compete, the net effect still favors China (0.36 and 0.28 points). Mechanism analyses suggest that CGTN videos work mainly by improving perceptions of China's performance rather than of its democratic qualities.

3 Replication

3.1 Data and Sample

The replication package includes the raw Qualtrics exports, the authors' cleaning script, and the cleaned analysis dataset. I start from the cleaned dataset rather than the raw exports for one reason. The authors impute missing covariates with the R package `mice`, and the imputed values depend on R's random number generator. They cannot be reproduced exactly in Python, so re-running the imputation would produce small differences in the covariate-adjusted estimates that reflect software rather than substance. I read the authors' cleaning script line by line and confirmed every step that affects the analysis sample.

The cleaned file contains 12,941 respondents, of whom 6,276 were randomized. Table 1 shows where the others left the survey. The categories are mutually exclusive and follow the order of the questionnaire. More than two in five respondents who completed the attention checks failed them, so the analysis sample is selected toward attentive respondents. This selection happens before randomization, so it does not threaten the comparison between arms, but it does define the population to which the estimates apply.

Table 1: Construction of the analysis sample

Stage	Respondents
Screened out: not a citizen of the survey country	955
Left before the attention checks	859
Failed an attention check	4,830
Passed the checks but left before randomization	21
Randomized	**6,276**
Total in the authors' cleaned dataset	12,941

Note: Respondents who left before randomization have no treatment assignment and no outcome data, so they drop out of every model in the original analysis. The authors' cleaning script also removes a separate Japan experiment and respondents with no country; neither group is in the cleaned file.

3.2 Specification

I estimate, separately for each outcome Y_i,

$$Y_i = \alpha + \beta_1 \,\text{China}_i + \beta_2 \,\text{USA}_i + \beta_3 \,\text{Competition}_i + \mathbf{X}_i'\boldsymbol{\gamma} + \varepsilon_i, \tag{1}$$

where Control is the omitted category and $\mathbf{X}_i$ contains country fixed effects and the five covariates entered linearly, exactly as in the authors' code. The unadjusted model omits $\mathbf{X}_i$. Standard errors are HC2, the default of the `estimatr` package the authors use. With only treatment indicators on the right-hand side, HC2 coincides with the conservative Neyman variance estimator for a difference in means (Samii and Aronow 2012).

Three implementation details turned out to matter. First, the Python reader for R data files does not preserve the order of R factor levels: it sorts the treatment arms alphabetically, which would silently make China rather than Control the reference category. I restore the original order explicitly. Second, the country identifier must remain a string. In both R and Python, the reference country for string identifiers is the first in lexical order (code "10", Kenya), which determines the constant in the adjusted model. Third, the standard error type must be specified explicitly, because Python's default is not HC2.

3.3 Results

Table 2 reports the replicated estimates. Every coefficient, standard error, and sample size is identical to the published Table A3 when rounded to two decimals; an automated cell-by-cell comparison is included in the code repository. Figure 1 displays the covariate-adjusted effects. Adjusting for covariates barely moves the point estimates (for the China arm's effect on the political model, from 1.045 to 1.040) and modestly shrinks the standard errors, as expected when treatment is randomized and covariates are prognostic.

Table 2: Replication of the primary results (Mattingly et al. 2025, Table A3)

	Covariate-adjusted		Unadjusted	
	Political	Economic	Political	Economic
China	1.04 (0.05)	0.87 (0.05)	1.05 (0.05)	0.87 (0.06)
USA	−0.43 (0.04)	−0.57 (0.05)	−0.44 (0.04)	−0.58 (0.05)
Competition	0.36 (0.05)	0.28 (0.06)	0.37 (0.05)	0.28 (0.06)
Constant	3.32 (0.20)	3.76 (0.23)	2.56 (0.03)	2.88 (0.04)
Covariates and country FE	Yes	Yes	No	No
N	5,952	5,946	5,952	5,946

Note: OLS estimates with HC2 robust standard errors in parentheses. Outcomes range from 1 (strongly prefer the US model) to 6 (strongly prefer the Chinese model). Covariates are gender, age, education, national pride, and left–right ideology. All entries match the published values at two decimals.

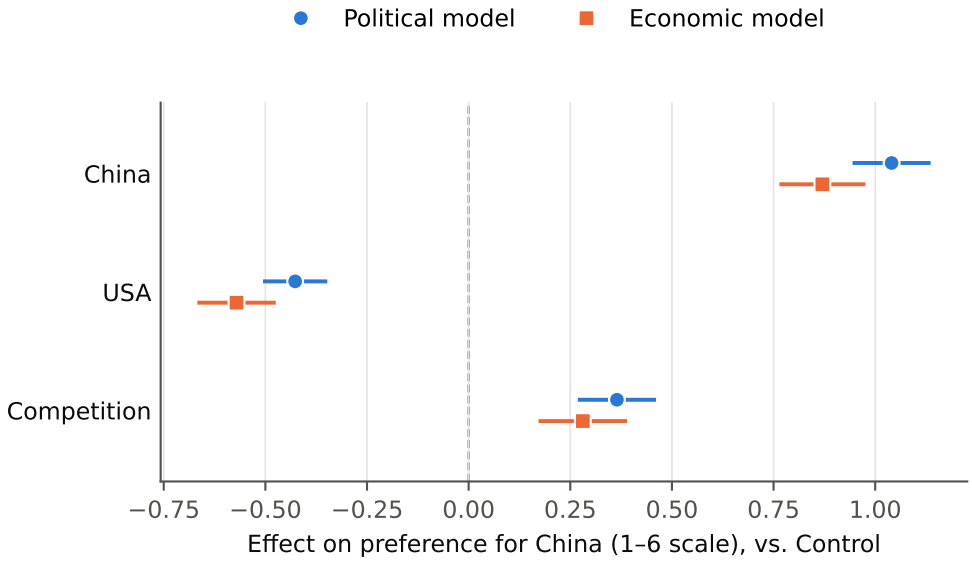


Figure 1: Covariate-adjusted effects of each treatment arm relative to Control. Points are OLS estimates; lines are 95% confidence intervals based on HC2 standard errors.

To convey magnitude, I follow the authors in dividing the unadjusted effects by the control-group standard deviation of each outcome. The China treatment moves preference for China's political

model by 0.87 standard deviations and for its economic model by 0.59, both large by the standards of survey experiments. In raw terms, the share of respondents preferring China's political model rises from 16.3 percent in the control group to 54.3 percent in the China arm.

4 Extension: Unbundling the Treatments

4.1 Motivation

The replication confirms that a bundle of two CGTN videos is highly persuasive. It does not tell us which content does the work. If the effect operates through performance information, as the authors argue, videos about economic achievement might be especially effective, perhaps even for views about the political model. Alternatively, persuasion might depend on features of particular videos, in which case the effect of "Chinese state media" would depend on which messages audiences happen to see.

The second possibility is a familiar concern in experimental research. When a treatment is represented by one or a few stimuli, its estimated effect may reflect idiosyncrasies of those stimuli rather than the category they stand for (Wells and Windschitl 1999). Clifford, Leeper, and Rainey (2024) show that the effects of party cues vary considerably across the policy topics used to deliver them, and Hewitt et al. (2024) find meaningful variation in the persuasive effects of hundreds of campaign advertisements that common theories of persuasiveness predict poorly. At the same time, Coppock (2023) shows that a given message tends to move different kinds of people in the same direction and by similar amounts. Together these studies suggest that variation in persuasion lies more in messages than in audiences, which makes the eight videos in this experiment a natural place to look.

4.2 How Videos Were Assigned

The data record the identifiers of the two videos each respondent saw. Cross-tabulating them reveals the assignment rule.

China and USA arms. The paper states that respondents in these arms "were randomly assigned at least one video from the pool of videos about the country's political model, and then randomly assigned a second video about either the political or economic model." In the data, the first video variable is drawn roughly uniformly from all four of a country's videos, and the second is then fixed: it is `pol2` unless the first video is `pol2`, in which case it is `pol1` (Table 3). This rule satisfies the paper's guarantee of at least one political video, but it means that every respondent in the China arm saw `china_pol2`, every respondent in the USA arm saw `us_pol2`, and `pol1` was never paired with an economic video. Only the *companion* of `pol2` was randomized: `pol1` for about half of respondents, and one of the two economic videos for a quarter each.

Holding `pol2` fixed, comparing respondents whose companion was economic with those whose companion was political estimates the causal effect of substituting economic for political content.

Table 3: Video assignment in the China and USA arms

China arm			USA arm		
First variable	Second variable	n	First variable	Second variable	n
`china_econ1`	`china_pol2`	415	`us_econ1`	`us_pol2`	411
`china_econ2`	`china_pol2`	429	`us_econ2`	`us_pol2`	383
`china_pol1`	`china_pol2`	396	`us_pol1`	`us_pol2`	385
`china_pol2`	`china_pol1`	382	`us_pol2`	`us_pol1`	386

Note: Randomized respondents. No other combinations occur. The raw survey exports, including incomplete responses, show the same rule.

The cost is that the separate effect of `pol2` cannot be identified in these arms.

Competition arm. One US video and one Chinese video were each drawn from all four of the country's videos, independently of each other. All sixteen combinations occur, each with 79 to 107 respondents, and a chi-squared test does not reject independence of the two assignments ($\chi^2 = 10.42$, $df = 9$, $p = 0.32$). This four-by-four factorial identifies the effect of each Chinese video relative to the others while the US video is balanced by randomization, and vice versa.

Video order. The codebook labels the cleaned first video variable as the "First Video Watched by Respondent." The paper states that in the Competition arm the order of the two countries' videos was "randomized with equal probability." In the data, however, the first video variable records the US video for every Competition-arm respondent. These three facts cannot all hold. Either the variables record videos by slot rather than by display order, or the US video always played first. The replication package contains no display-order field or survey flow file, so the public data cannot settle the question. I therefore do not study order effects, and I check whether the companion-video comparison is robust to the possibility that the first variable records the first video shown.

4.3 Estimation

For the China and USA arms, I estimate within each arm

$$Y_i = \alpha + \delta \, \text{EconCompanion}_i + \mathbf{X}_i'\boldsymbol{\gamma} + \varepsilon_i, \tag{2}$$

where δ is the effect of an economic rather than political companion video. I estimate Equation 2 for the two primary outcomes and for each of the eight perception items the authors use to study mechanisms, asking China-arm respondents about China and USA-arm respondents about the United States. For the Competition arm, I estimate

$$Y_i = \alpha + \theta_C \, \text{ChinaEcon}_i + \theta_U \, \text{USEcon}_i + \mathbf{X}_i'\boldsymbol{\gamma} + \varepsilon_i, \tag{3}$$

both as written and with an interaction between the two indicators, and a version with indicators for each specific video, using `pol2` as the reference for each country because it is the video held fixed in the single-country arms. All models use the same covariates and HC2 standard errors as the replication. Within each family of tests I report p-values adjusted by the Holm (1979) and Benjamini–Hochberg (1995) procedures, which the authors also use. For the single-country comparisons I report the minimum detectable effect (MDE) at 80 percent power and a two-sided 5 percent test, MDE $= (z_{0.975} + z_{0.80}) \times \text{SE} \approx 2.8 \times \text{SE}$.

4.4 Economic versus Political Content

Table 4 and Figure 2 report the companion-video comparisons. In the China arm, replacing a second political video with an economic one raises preference for China's economic model by 0.26 points (SE 0.08; Holm-adjusted $p = 0.004$), nearly a third of the full China-arm effect on that outcome. The same substitution has no detectable effect on preference for China's political model: the estimate is 0.01 (SE 0.08), with a confidence interval from -0.14 to 0.16. Given an MDE of 0.21, the data rule out large differences, though not modest ones. In the USA arm, neither difference is distinguishable from zero.

Table 4: Effect of an economic rather than political companion video

Arm	Outcome	Estimate	SE	Holm p	BH p	MDE	N
China	Political model	0.009	0.076	1.000	0.905	0.214	1,527
China	Economic model	0.256	0.077	0.004	0.004	0.216	1,526
USA	Political model	0.076	0.053	0.456	0.304	0.149	1,489
USA	Economic model	0.011	0.065	1.000	0.905	0.182	1,487

Note: Each row is a separate OLS regression within one arm (Equation 2), with country fixed effects, covariates, and HC2 standard errors. Positive values mean more favorable to China. p-values are adjusted across the four tests. MDE: minimum detectable effect at 80% power, $\alpha = 0.05$.

Robustness to video position. If the first video variable records the first video shown, the comparison above is partly confounded with position: economic companions always played before `pol2`, whereas `pol1` played before `pol2` for only half of the political-companion group. Table 5 addresses this in two ways. First, I restrict each arm to respondents for whom `pol2` is the second video, so that position is identical across the two groups. The China-arm effect on the economic model is essentially unchanged (0.24, SE 0.10), and the effect on the political model remains close to zero. Second, among respondents who saw two political videos, I compare those who saw `pol2` first with those who saw it second. None of the four differences is distinguishable from zero. The main finding therefore holds under either reading of the video variables.

Relation to the authors' video-type analysis. The authors' replication code contains an exploratory version of this comparison that is not reported in the paper or its appendix. It regresses

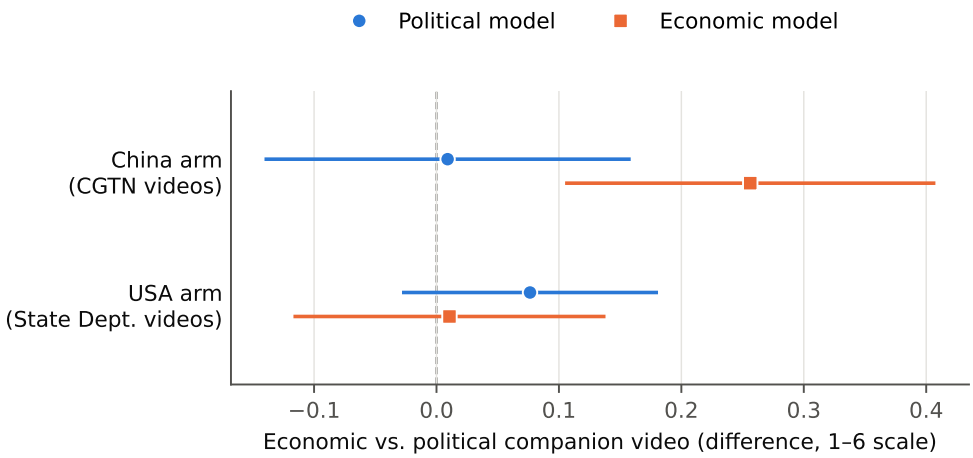


Figure 2: Effect of an economic rather than political companion video within the China and USA arms. Points are OLS estimates; lines are unadjusted 95% confidence intervals.

Table 5: Robustness of the companion-video comparison to video position

		pol2 second for all (economic companion effect)		*pol2* first vs. second (two political videos)	
Arm	Outcome	Estimate (SE)	N	Estimate (SE)	N
China	Political model	−0.043 (0.095)	1,174	−0.117 (0.114)	732
China	Economic model	0.237 (0.095)	1,173	−0.028 (0.115)	732
USA	Political model	0.076 (0.066)	1,120	−0.020 (0.074)	742
USA	Economic model	0.073 (0.079)	1,119	0.097 (0.092)	741

Note: OLS with country fixed effects, covariates, and HC2 standard errors. Left: Equation 2 estimated among respondents whose second video variable is `pol2`. Right: among respondents who saw two political videos, the difference between those whose first video variable is `pol2` and those whose second is. Unadjusted p-values for the right-hand estimates range from 0.29 to 0.81.

each outcome on the type of the first video variable (Chinese economic, Chinese political, US economic, US political, or control) with the same covariates. Its Chinese economic-minus-political contrast is 0.25 (SE 0.08) for the economic model and 0.00 for the political model, essentially identical to the estimates in Table 4. The specification has one feature worth noting. Because the first video variable always records the US video in the Competition arm, Competition-arm respondents are coded as having seen a US video and are pooled with the USA arm. The resulting US coefficients for the political model, −0.003 and −0.068, average a negative effect in the USA arm with a positive effect in the Competition arm. Giving the two arms separate categories, in line with the paper's own description of the design as having six groups including "China + US," recovers effects of −0.39 and −0.47 for the USA arm and +0.39 and +0.34 for the Competition arm (Appendix Table A2).

4.5 Which Perceptions Does Content Change?

The authors argue that CGTN persuades by improving perceptions of China's performance. If economic content persuades within its own domain, it should be economic videos that improve perceptions that China delivers growth. Figure 3 shows that this is not the case. In the China arm, an economic companion video has no detectable effect on perceptions that China delivers economic growth (−0.04, SE 0.06). Instead, it improves perceptions that China selects competent leaders by 0.26 points *less* than a political companion video (SE 0.07; Holm-adjusted $p = 0.002$ across the eight items). No other difference survives adjustment. In the USA arm, the economic companion video raises perceptions of US growth by 0.13 points (SE 0.06), but this estimate does not survive adjustment (Holm $p = 0.14$).

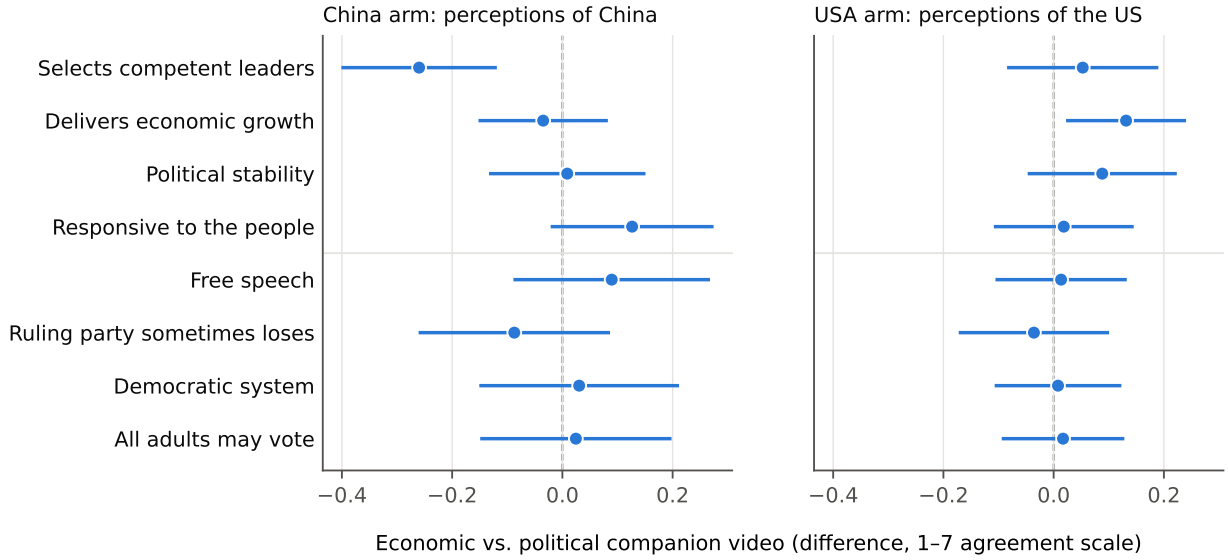


Figure 3: Effect of an economic rather than political companion video on perceptions of the arm's country, by item. Items above the line form the authors' performance dimension; items below form the democracy dimension. Lines are unadjusted 95% confidence intervals.

One plausible reason the economic videos do not move growth perceptions is that there is little room to move them. In the control group, 52 percent of respondents already rate China's growth performance at 6 or 7 on the seven-point scale, compared with 32 percent for leadership competence. The economic videos may raise preference for China's economic model by reinforcing a belief respondents already hold rather than by changing it, while the political video, which is the companion in the comparison group, appears to convey something new about China's leadership. This interpretation is speculative, since the experiment was not designed to separate these channels.

4.6 Individual Videos in Competition

Table 6 reports the type-level estimates from the Competition arm. A Chinese economic video, compared with a Chinese political one, raises preference for China's political model by 0.28 points

and for its economic model by 0.56 points; both survive the Holm correction. On the US side, economic and political videos have the same effect on the political outcome, but a US economic video pulls respondents 0.24 points further toward the US economic model. The interaction terms are negative but imprecise and not significant.

Table 6: Effects of video type in the Competition arm

	Political model		Economic model	
	Estimate (SE)	Holm p	Estimate (SE)	Holm p
Additive model				
Chinese video is economic	0.282 (0.078)	0.001	0.560 (0.082)	<0.001
US video is economic	0.023 (0.077)	0.767	−0.235 (0.082)	0.008
Interaction model				
Chinese econ. × US econ.	−0.178 (0.155)	—	−0.253 (0.165)	—
N	1,459		1,456	

Note: OLS estimates within the Competition arm (Equation 3) with country fixed effects, covariates, and HC2 standard errors. Reference categories are political videos. Holm p-values are adjusted across the four main effects. The interaction is exploratory; its unadjusted p-values are 0.25 and 0.13.

The type-level averages, however, hide substantial variation across individual videos (Figure 4; Appendix Table A1). Relative to `china_pol2`, each of the other three CGTN videos raises preference for China's political model by between 0.45 and 0.61 points. The other political video, `china_pol1` (0.48), is about as effective as the economic video `china_econ2` (0.45). The economic-versus-political gap on the political outcome is therefore driven by one weak political video rather than by content type. On the economic outcome, both economic videos (0.97 and 0.70) do outperform `china_pol1` (0.54). Among US videos, the two economic videos are the most effective at shifting views of the economic model, while the four videos are indistinguishable on the political model.

4.7 Two Designs, One Pattern

The single-country arms and the Competition arm are independent samples with different designs, so it is informative to compare them. The Competition estimates imply that, relative to `china_pol1`, the average CGTN economic video changes preference for China's political model by 0.05 points and its economic model by 0.30 points. The corresponding within-China-arm estimates are 0.01 and 0.26. For the US videos, the two designs agree on the political outcome (0.05 versus 0.08) but diverge on the economic outcome (−0.14 versus 0.01). These implied contrasts are computed from point estimates without their own standard errors, and individual video coefficients have standard errors of about 0.11, so the comparison is suggestive rather than a formal test. The US discrepancy could be noise, or US economic messages could matter more when they compete directly with Chinese ones.

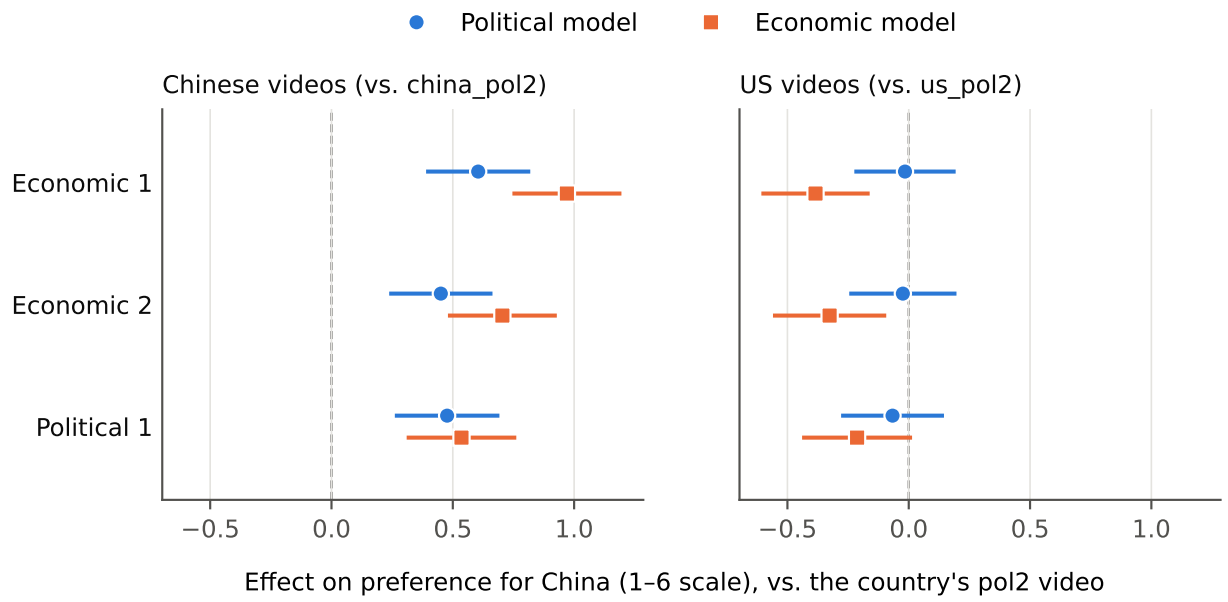


Figure 4: Effect of each video relative to its country's `pol2` video in the Competition arm. Chinese-video estimates control for the US video and vice versa. Lines are unadjusted 95% confidence intervals.

5 Discussion

The original study shows that Chinese state media can shift global opinion. The extension suggests that *what* it says shapes how much opinion moves, and through which perceptions. Three conclusions follow.

First, content persuades within its own domain at the level of model preferences, but not through the most obvious channel. CGTN's economic videos raise preference for China's economic model but not, beyond a second political video, for its political model. Yet they do not improve perceptions of China's growth, which are already high, whereas political content does more to improve perceptions of China's leadership. This refines the performance-legitimacy account: which dimension of performance a message moves depends on what audiences already believe, and the most effective content may be content that tells audiences something new.

Second, individual messages differ substantially, and these differences are not explained by broad content categories. The most and least persuasive CGTN videos in the Competition arm differ by about 0.6 points on the political model and nearly 1 point on the economic model, comparable in size to the paper's main effects. This is consistent with research finding that persuasive effects vary across messages in ways that are hard to predict from their content type (Hewitt et al. 2024).

Third, these results bear on the interpretation of the headline estimate. Every respondent in the China arm saw `china_pol2`, which was the least persuasive CGTN video in the Competition arm. The China-arm effect is a valid estimate of the effect of the bundles that were actually shown. However, it may be conservative relative to other combinations of CGTN content. This is an inference across arms rather than a direct estimate: no respondent in the China arm saw a pair

without `china_pol2`, and the relative strength of videos could differ when they are not paired with a US video.

Limitations. The extension relies on four videos per country. "Economic" and "political" videos also differ in length, style, and subject, so contrasts between types are best read as contrasts between these specific videos rather than between content categories in general. Within-arm subsamples are smaller than the arms, so the MDEs of 0.15 to 0.22 points mean that modest differences may go undetected, and the interaction estimates in the Competition arm are too imprecise to be informative. The mechanism results rest on single survey items, examine eight outcomes per arm, and offer only a speculative explanation for the null effect on growth perceptions. Finally, the replication package does not include the survey flow file, so the assignment rule is inferred from the data and the conflict between the codebook and the paper about video order cannot be resolved.

Future directions. The video-level variation documented here invites a direct study of message features. Following the logic of topic sampling (Clifford, Leeper, and Rainey 2024), a new experiment could draw many CGTN and US messages at random from the corpora the authors assembled, code them for performance claims, criticism of the United States, use of statistics, and production quality, and estimate how these features predict persuasiveness. Recovering the display order from the original survey platform would also make it possible to test whether the first or the last message has the advantage when Chinese and US narratives compete.

Data and Code

All code is available at `https://github.com/maeve5ood/mattingly-china-model-replication`. A single command (`python run_all.py`) reproduces every table and figure from the authors' replication data (Harvard Dataverse, `https://doi.org/10.7910/DVN/CQ4FZR`).

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Appendix

Table A1: Effect of each video relative to its country's `pol2`, Competition arm

	Political model			Economic model		
Video	Estimate (SE)	Holm p	BH p	Estimate (SE)	Holm p	BH p
`china_econ1`	0.605 (0.110)	<0.001	<0.001	0.970 (0.115)	<0.001	<0.001
`china_econ2`	0.451 (0.109)	<0.001	<0.001	0.704 (0.114)	<0.001	<0.001
`china_pol1`	0.477 (0.110)	<0.001	<0.001	0.536 (0.115)	<0.001	<0.001
`us_econ1`	−0.015 (0.107)	1.000	0.885	−0.384 (0.114)	0.004	0.001
`us_econ2`	−0.024 (0.113)	1.000	0.885	−0.326 (0.119)	0.031	0.009
`us_pol1`	−0.067 (0.108)	1.000	0.644	−0.213 (0.116)	0.262	0.087
N	1,459			1,456		

Note: One regression per outcome, including indicators for the Chinese video (reference `china_pol2`) and the US video (reference `us_pol2`), country fixed effects, covariates, and HC2 standard errors. p-values are adjusted across all twelve coefficients.

Table A2: The authors' video-type specification, pooled and split by arm

	Political model	Economic model
As in the replication code (Competition arm coded by its US video)		
Chinese economic	1.040 (0.061)	0.988 (0.066)
Chinese political	1.040 (0.064)	0.741 (0.067)
US economic	−0.003 (0.046)	−0.191 (0.053)
US political	−0.068 (0.046)	−0.108 (0.054)
Chinese economic − Chinese political	0.001 (0.078)	0.248 (0.078)
USA and Competition arms coded separately		
USA arm, economic companion video	−0.388 (0.049)	−0.567 (0.059)
USA arm, two political videos	−0.466 (0.048)	−0.575 (0.059)
Competition arm, US economic video	0.385 (0.063)	0.188 (0.068)
Competition arm, US political video	0.344 (0.062)	0.376 (0.070)
N	5,952	5,946

Note: All coefficients are relative to the control group, with country fixed effects, covariates, and HC2 standard errors, following `7. mechanism_analysis.R` in the replication package. In the USA arm, an economic first video variable corresponds to an economic companion of `us_pol2`, and a political one to two political videos. Chinese coefficients from the split model are omitted.